

My name is Dorth Arenas, and I want to become a physician, more specifically an orthopedic surgeon. Dorth is not only my name; it is also my father's. Because it is unusual, sharing it with him has always made me feel that I inherited part of his identity. My father is an orthopedic surgeon, and I knew I would pursue my journey of becoming a physician since the first time I went to my father's office, since the first time I saw him attending his patients with dedication but a smile on his face while attending to them and after a long day of work. As a kid, I wondered what made my father so passionate about his job, because as the son of an orthopedic surgeon, I saw the personal sacrifices required by a career in medicine. I share all of his hobbies, I have always looked up my father because he is my hero and the most important person in the world, however, through my childhood and adolescence I had what is called, an absent father, my hero despite all the admiration I had for him, was not there for me as I would prefer, or as my classmates had their fathers with them. I saw my father going to work right after dropping me off at school in the morning and not seeing him again until the next morning to take me to school again. I used to stay up until very late just to see him arriving tired from work. Unfortunately, my father missed many of my parents' events during my school time; he missed many of my soccer practices and games. Therefore, I used to ask myself why me. I had a father who healed and helped people, a lot of times for free without any reward; rather than serving others, but it was that passion for helping others that was all about. I learned to admire him for how someone could risk his own health, especially mentally, just to help others. Because having the dedication and ability to heal others is the greatest gift god gave him, he says. Therefore, in my determination of wanting to be like my father, having the gift of healing others, I set out on a journey to prepare myself to be just as good as him.

When I was 12 years old my father took for the first time to one of his surgeries, even though I could not understand what was happening I tried to learn the little details beside this profession, how do the surgeons prepare, who are the team or heroes that are not the physicians that work with dedication behind a surgery, because I learned that in the medical field teamwork is one of the fundamentals, being a leader is another of the fundamentals. I was amazed the first time I saw my father as a leader in the surgical room, leading his team to save someone else's life. I started going every time I could with him to work, not just to spend more time with my own father but to learn from him. My first job was being a medical assistant for my father; I learned about the methodology of a physician from a closer look, scribing the different cases and assisting him during the patients' appointments. One of the hobbies I inherited from my father were the practicing and dedication for sports and physical activity, therefore, as an athlete I was interested about the different injuries athletes go through, my father works also a sport doctor for the national teams in my home country Venezuela, therefore I developed an interest in sports medicine, I remember the first time I saw an ACL injury, the infiltration and recovery of the athletes seeing them during their recovery process to perform at the greatest ability again, I found this inspiring being part of this process for athletes.

At the age of 17, I moved to the United States to follow my dream of becoming a physician. Far from my family and comfort zone, I made the decision to keep my preparation to become a physician and try to learn from the best physicians in the world, who I consider to be in this country. I pursued a bachelor's in biomedical science at the University of Central Florida with the intention of acquiring the best education possible. I took several courses to keep improving my knowledge in health and sciences, such as Honors Anatomy, Human Physiology, and

Immunology, among others. Also I had the opportunity to begin a journey in undergraduate research by performing a undergraduate research project in bioinformatics with the mentorship of Dr. Rita Luther at Valencia College in Orlando Florida and the presented in the research showcase in the mentioned institution but also in the University of Central Florida 20th annual student research symposium, additionally, I worked in the lab of Dr. Hwan Choi with the mentorship of him and Dr. Sy Nguyen being this my first research lab opportunity plus allow me to research and acquire the knowledge in an interested area for me such as biomechanics and orthopedics.

Additionally, during my time in Orlando Florida, I worked as a lifeguard at Universal Studios Resorts. This was my first opportunity as a first aid responder; it was a valuable experience because I gained experience working and assisting people through life-threatening situations, such as drowning, burning, seizures, and more. This reinforced my passion for helping and assisting others and gave me the practice of doing so from the perspective of a lifeguard. Additionally, I had the opportunity to become a volunteer at the Orlando Health surgery guest services department for more than 150 hours, where I learned more about the medical setting and reconnecting with my roots from when I used to work with my father as his medical assistant, working with physicians and assisting the guests of patients who undergo surgery or other treatments.

In the short term, I plan to complete my Biomedical Sciences degree, continue participating in research, pursue opportunities to publish and expand my clinical experience, and enter medical school. I also want to keep improving how I communicate scientific and medical information because trust depends on a physician's ability to make complex decisions understandable. I want to be a good orthopedic surgeon like my father, but I also want to discover myself, to keep learning from the process, mentors, colleagues, and experiences. In the long term, I want to be able to combine orthopedics with the field of sports medicine while contributing to research on athletic injury, recovery, and rehabilitation. I hope to help athletes regain the ability and confidence to return to the activities that give their lives meaning, and one day I would be honored to collaborate and work alongside my father. I want the name Dorth to be a representation of two physicians who shared the same values, but also are distinguished by the contributions each made to the people and community they helped.